

Reed Avenue Rail Corridor – 6th Penny Work Session

October 10, 2025



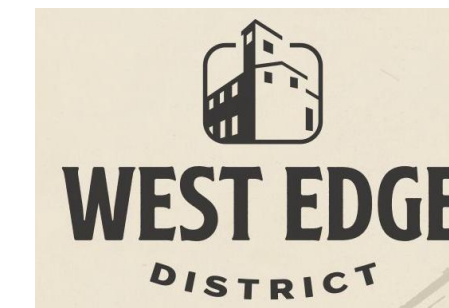
Agenda

- Introduction and Background
- Project Limits and Goals
- Project Timeline
- Project Status Update
 - BNSF Diagnostics Meeting
 - 30% Plan Overview
 - 30% Plan BNSF/ Olson Comment Summary
- Proposed Pilot Project
- Next Steps
 - Reed Avenue Corridor Steering Committee Report
 - Councilmen Laybourn
 - 6th Penny Project Proposal

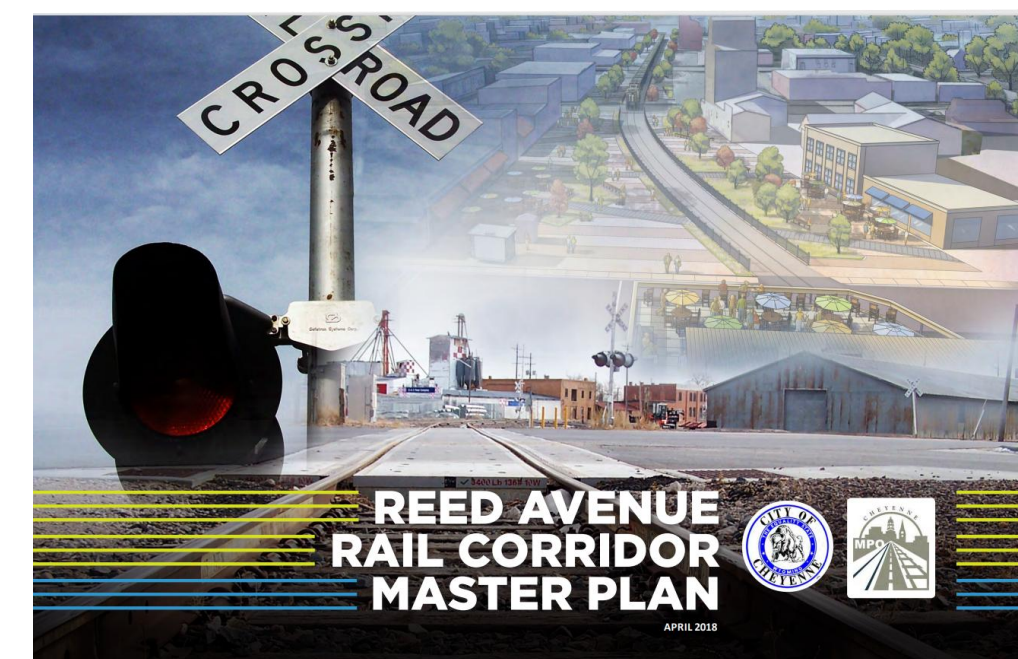
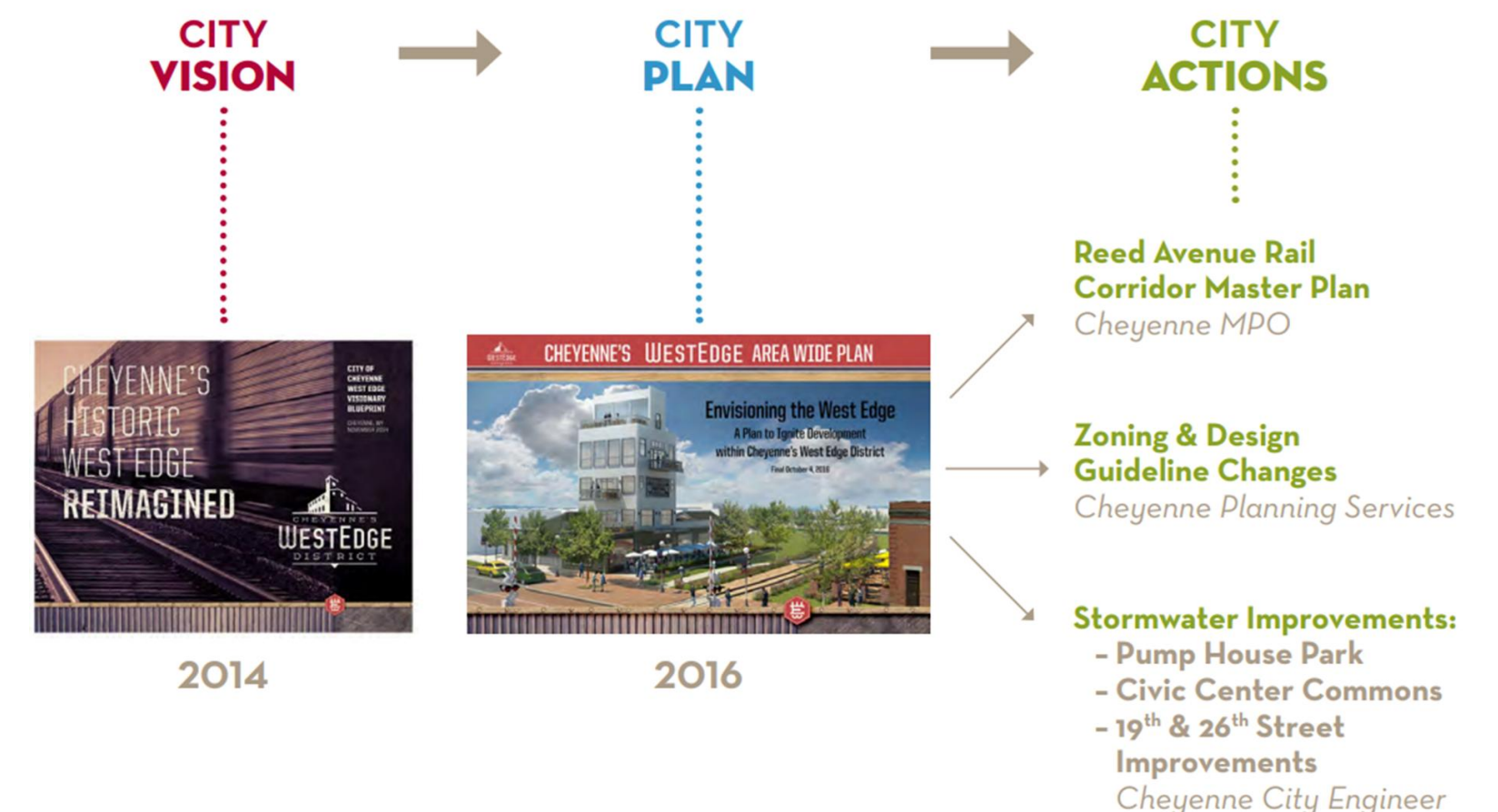


Introduction and Background

- The **Reed Avenue Corridor improvements** were first proposed in the **West Edge Visionary Blueprint** and later codified in the **West Edge Area-Wide Plan** to support economic redevelopment of Cheyenne's west side.
- In **2018**, the **Cheyenne MPO** developed the **Reed Avenue Corridor Plan**, incorporating extensive public input and partially funded by the 6th Penny Sales Tax.
- Over a four-year period, the **West Edge planning and projects** attracted \$17 million in external **state and federal funding** through a strategic grant approach.
- For every **\$1 of public investment**, the West Edge has attracted **\$6 in private investment**, demonstrating strong confidence in the area's revitalization and robust return on public investment.



West Edge District Planning & Implementation Process

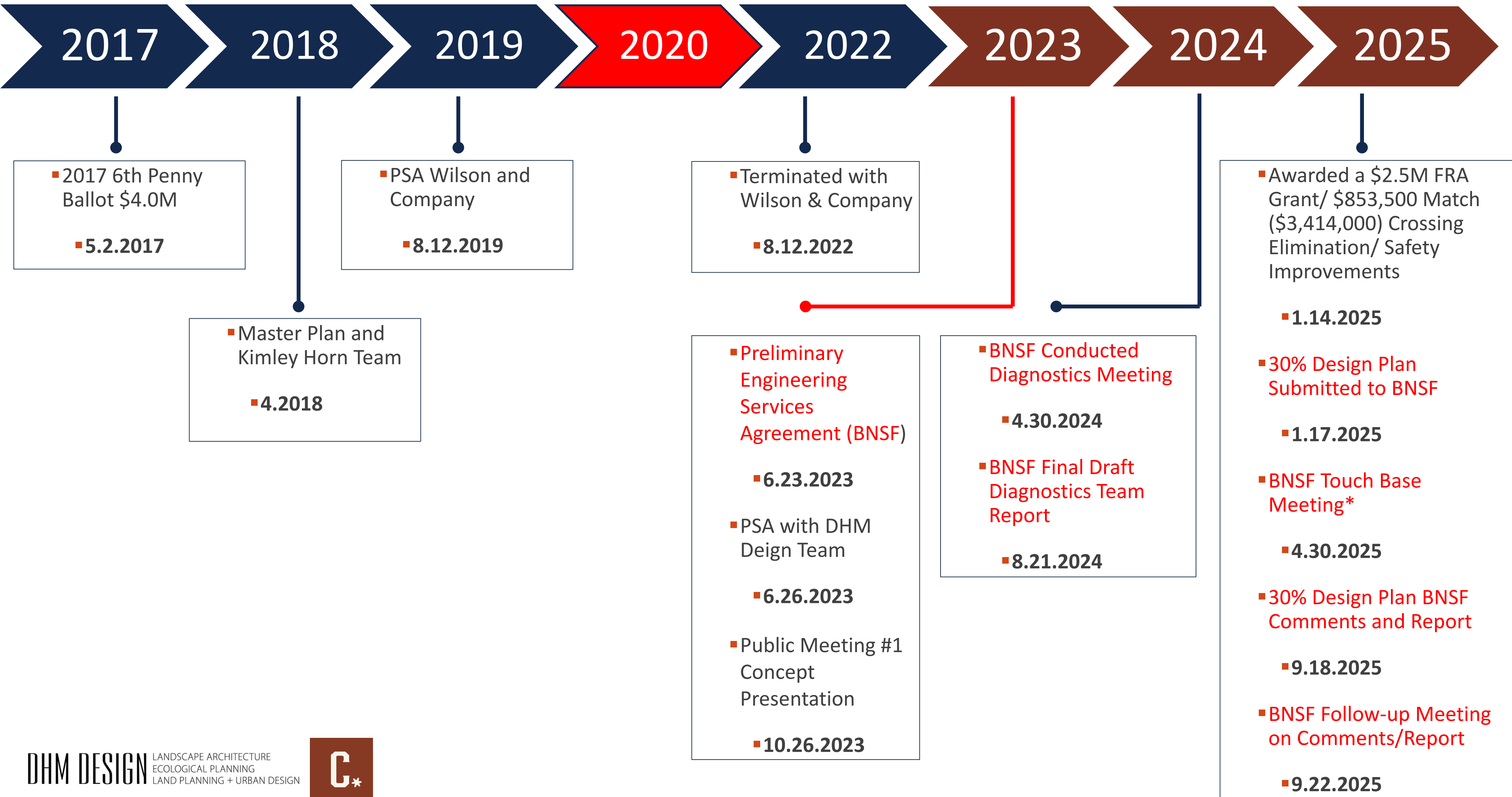


Project Limits and Goals

- Conceptual Design Project limits
 - Reed Avenue (BNSF Right-of-way)
 - Dillon Avenue to 15th Street
- Primary Goals
 - **Create an urban amenity** that is attractive to diverse land uses and catalyzes new investment in the **West Edge District** of Downtown Cheyenne.
 - **Develop an enhanced corridor** that extends the city-wide **bicycle and pedestrian greenway**, enhancing connectivity and active transportation.
 - **Improve operational safety** within both the City right-of-way and the BNSF right-of-way to support safe, efficient movement for all users.



Project Timeline



Project Status and Updates – Diagnostics Meeting

- Diagnostics Meeting Overview
 - Review of Existing/ Proposed Crossings
 - BNSF, Olson, UPRR, DHM (GLM, Quandel), WYDOT.
 - Action Items identified for immediate improvements:
 - Update/ refresh pavement markings
 - Stop Bars, Railroad Crossing
 - Remove and reset some signage.
 - Add additional “No Park” / No Semi-truck Parking Signs within 100’ of CL of Track



Project Status and Updates – Diagnostics Meeting

- Diagnostics Meeting Overview (Continued)
 - Overall positive meeting with cautionary optimism related to designs proposed by both BNSF/ Olson staff.
 - Potential Full Closures (17th, 18th, and Dillon Avenue)
 - Bungalow (Signal House) Replacement Required
 - Maintenance Road Security and Establishment
 - Railroad was concerned over the amount of use in the railroad “Right-of-way”.



Project Status and Updates – Diagnostics Meeting

- Diagnostics Meeting Overview (Continued)
 - Railroad was concerned over the amount of use in the railroad “Right-of-way”.
 - ABCS, INC (722 W 22ND ST); obstructions within right-of-way



Project Status and Updates – Diagnostics Meeting

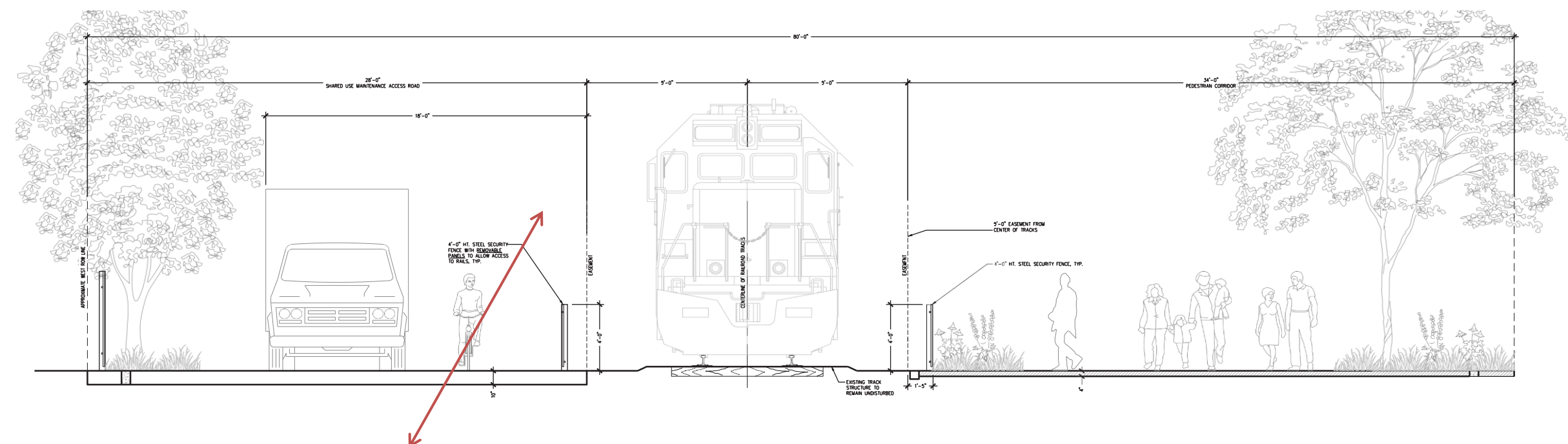
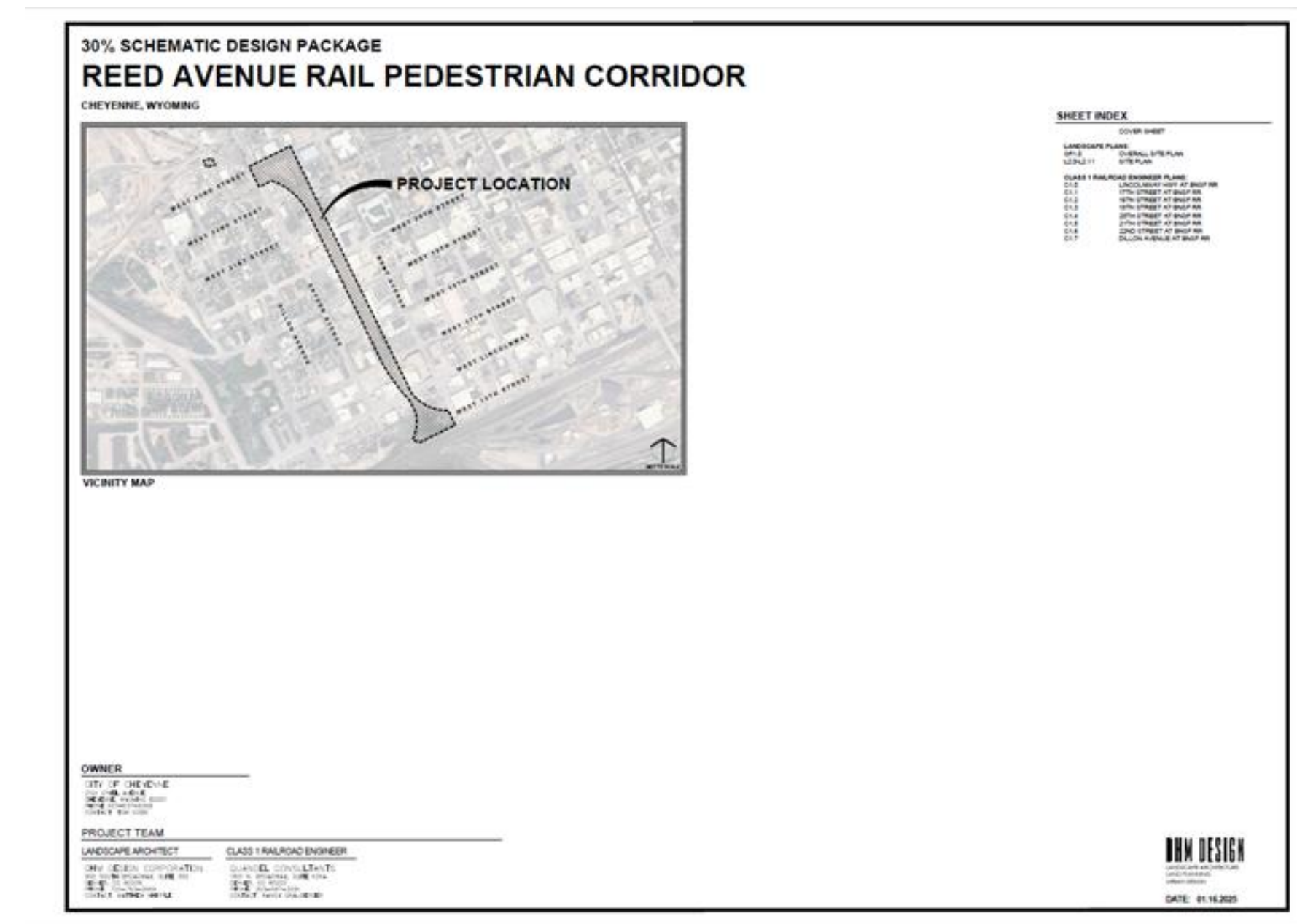
■ Diagnostics Meeting Overview (Continued)

- Railroad was concerned over the amount of use in the railroad “Right-of-way”.
- Durante Limited Liability Corporation (804 W 16TH ST)



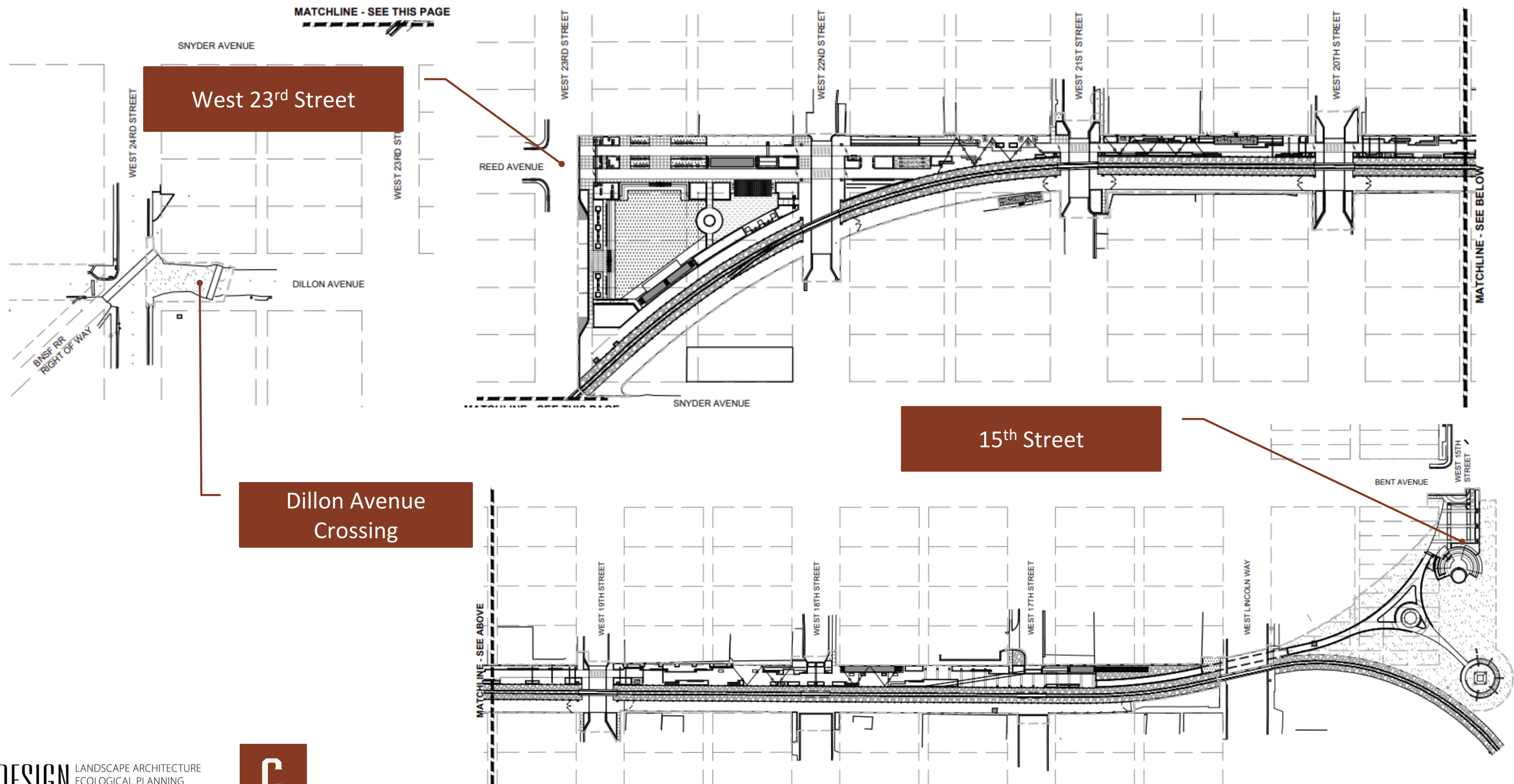
Project Status and Updates – 30% Plan Overview

- 30% Plan Overview
- Proposed Improvements
 - Construction of a **pedestrian promenade** on the east side and **BNSF maintenance access road** on the west side.
 - **Steel fencing** on both sides (removable on west for maintenance).
 - **Pedestrian tunnel under Lincoln Way** for grade-separated access.
 - **Crossing closures:** 17th St, 18th St, and Dillon Ave.
 - **Signal and crossing upgrades** at remaining streets (19th, 20th, 21st, 22nd, 23rd).
 - **Relocation of signal houses** to the west side of the tracks.



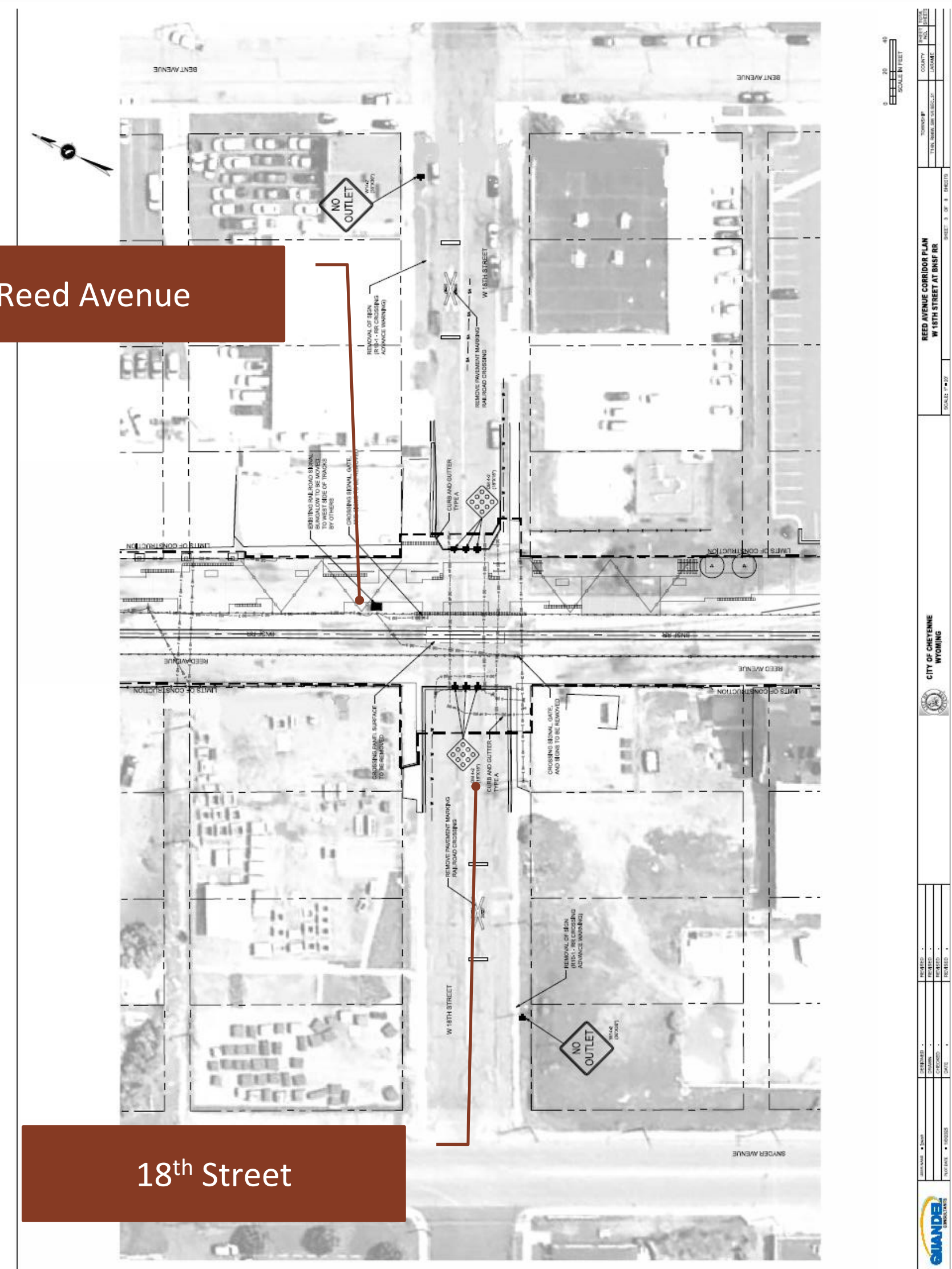
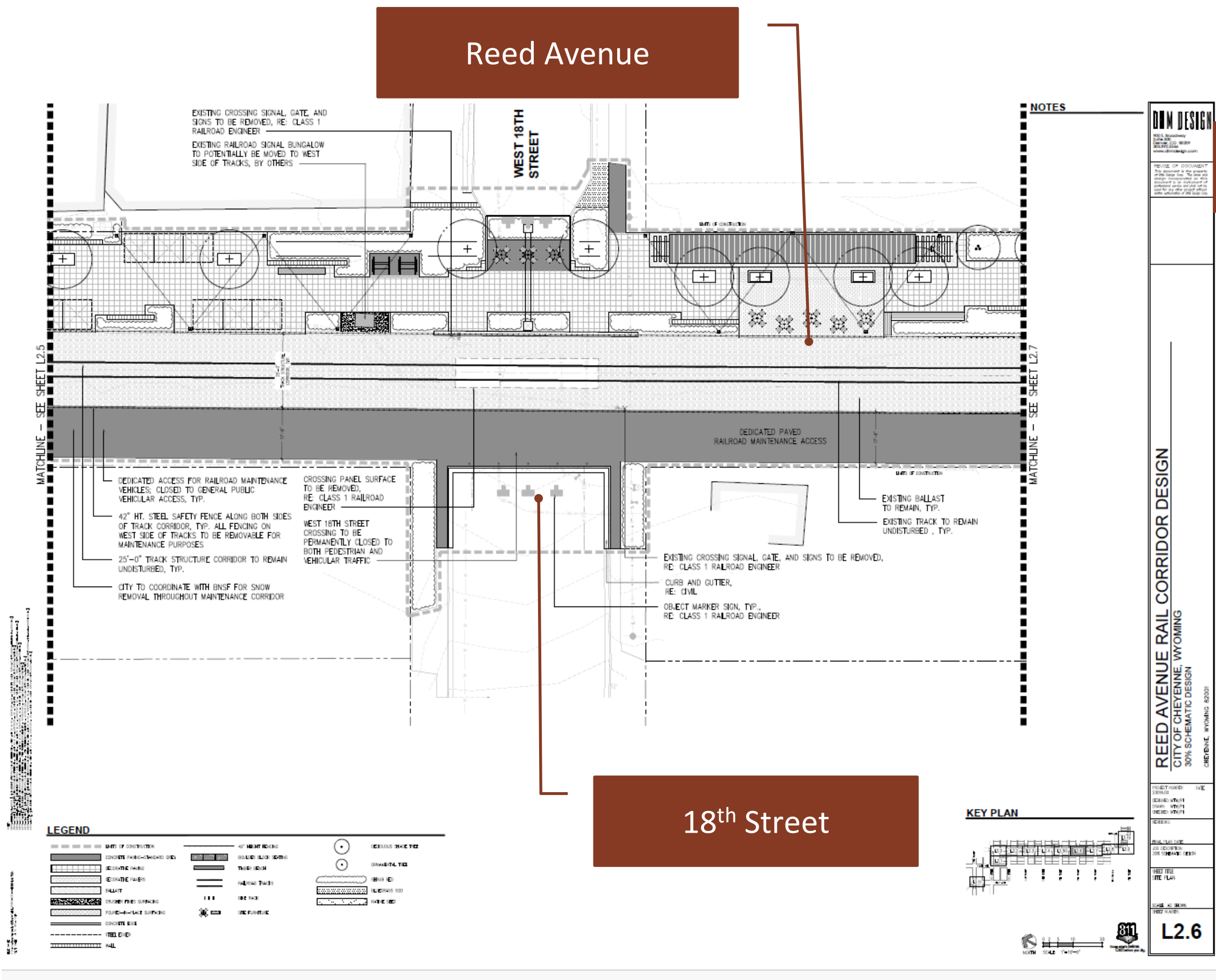
Project Status and Updates – 30% Plan Overview

■ 30% Plan Overview



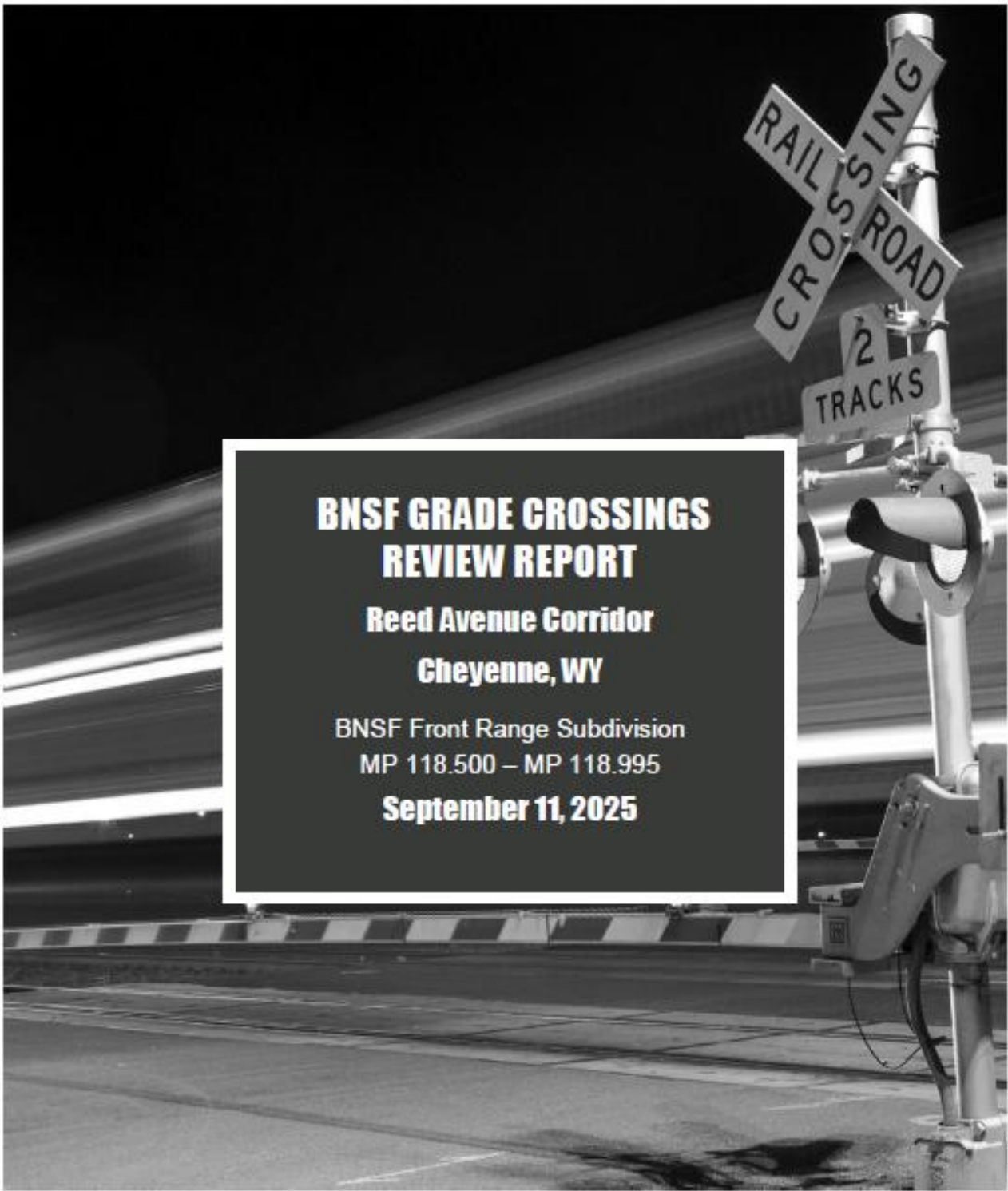
Project Status and Updates– 30% Plan Overview

- 30% Plan Overview – Landscape Plan/ Crossing Plan



Project Status and Updates

- 30% Plan BNSF/ Olson Comments
 - 72 Primary Comments and Suggestions Received
- Immediate Safety Actions
 - Remove signage encouraging unauthorized vehicle use along Reed Avenue.
 - Install “No Trespassing” signs on BNSF property.
 - Coordinate with property owners to adjust delivery operations near closed crossings.
 - Provide project history and intent documentation.



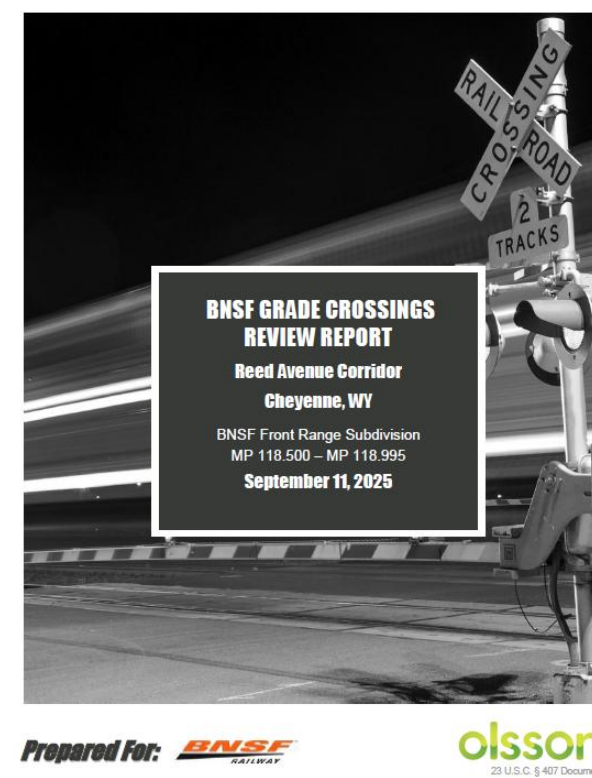
Grade Crossing Report Initial General Summary Table Reed Avenue Crossings, Cheyenne, Wyoming Reed Avenue Corridor Grade Crossings, Front Range Subdivision				
No.	Comment or Revision No.	BNSF Team Recommendation	Standard/Reference	Owner's Response (Y/N)
1	Immediate Action Item	Per diaphanous meeting minutes, the City should remove all signs facilitating the unauthorized use of the crossing.	Diaphanous Meeting	
		Provide status of coordination with property owners to change delivery operations due to 24th Street grade crossing closure. If delivery operations cannot be changed immediately, property owners should be notified.	Diaphanous Meeting	
	Item	Add "BNSF Property - No Trespassing" signs to Reed Avenue on both sides of the crossing.	Diaphanous Meeting	
	Item	Provide a project report to explain the history of the redevelopment project that is currently underway, history of the crossing, and the crossing's future.	Diaphanous Meeting	
		Per diaphanous meeting minutes, provide lighting.	Diaphanous Meeting	
		Provide Grade Crossing Exhibit detailing additional design details related to grade crossing, including lane widths, sidewalk widths, placement of crossing devices from	Recommended Practice	
		Provide Signage and Striping plan for 24th Street.		
		Provide track layout, including all crossings.		
		Specify BNSF ROW on all crossings.	Standard Practice	
		Reference to all utilities on the design plan sheets.	Recommended Practice	
		Provide detailed signage and striping plans for all crossings. Include all	For identification/revision purposes	
		existing signage and include		
		install detectable warning surfaces at the pedestrian approach to the grade crossing to be 2' upstream of grade crossing warning devices. For the off	MUTCD 8D.04 (2003) (Guidance): United States Bureau of Road and Transportation Builders Association Guidelines for Pedestrian Facilities (2011) DOT	
		Grade crossing surfaces used to extend at least 4' beyond sidewalk limits. Specify overall proposed crossing surface length in B-105 (overlaps due to	Standard Practice	
		Label each grade crossing DOT # and BNSF Subdivision on all sheets.	Standard Practice	
		Consider providing E crossing outside of grade crossing right-of-way.	ASHRAE 90.1-2010 as a Minimum Design of Highway and Streets (2011) Section 5.9.5	
		Per diaphanous meeting, specify the signage and/or	Diaphanous Meeting	

Notes: The following standards and/or conditions change, comments may be used.
Page 1 of 5

Project Status and Updates

- **30% Plan Comments BNSF/ Olson (Cont.)**
- **Design and Plan Revisions**
 - Add detailed grade crossing exhibits: lane widths, sidewalk widths, gate lengths, and device placements.
 - Include signing and striping plans for all crossings, especially 23rd Street.
 - Specify BNSF right-of-way (ROW) and utility references on all plan sheets.
- **Pedestrian and Accessibility Enhancements**
 - Install detectable warning surfaces at pedestrian approaches.
 - Ensure sidewalk routing behind gate mechanisms with proper clearances.
 - Consider active pedestrian warning devices in quadrants without vehicle gates.

- **Railroad Equipment and Access**
 - Review and potentially relocate signal bungalows.
 - Provide mountable curbs and maintenance access for BNSF.
 - Clarify pedestrian access restrictions and fencing near crossings.
- **Sight Distance and Landscaping**
 - Eliminate or reduce landscaping near crossings to maintain clear sight lines.
 - Provide unwalkable surfaces (e.g., ballast or decomposed granite) around warning devices.
- **Traffic Operations and Queuing**
 - Perform queuing analyses for 19th and 22nd Streets to assess vehicle stacking risks.
 - Adjust striping and signage to reflect intersection-like conditions at crossings.



Project Status and Updates

- **30% Plan Comments BNSF/ Olson (Cont.)**

- **Tunnel and Structural Considerations (Lincoln Way)**

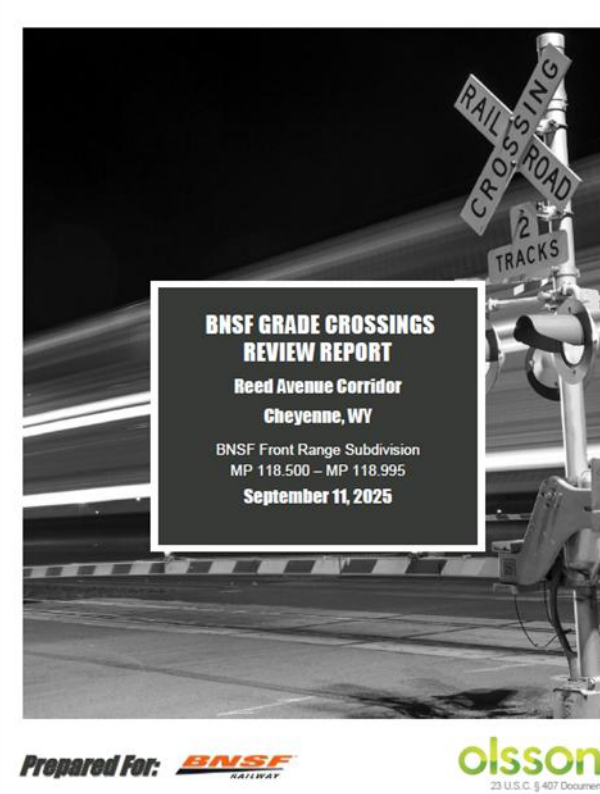
- Provide tunnel depth details, cross-sections, and construction methods.
- Confirm no conflicts with existing cantilever foundations or utilities Design and Plan Revisions

- **Most Frequent Comments (Top Issues)**

- Curb and sidewalk design near warning devices.
- Signal bungalow placement and potential relocation.
- Landscaping conflicts with sight lines.
- Maintenance access provisions.
- Pedestrian safety and routing.

- **Evaluation & Key Findings**

- **Closure of 21st Street is recommended** due to safety conflicts from truck deliveries encroaching on tracks.
- Warehouse 21 and Meadow Gold operations analyzed; alternative delivery options identified.
- Pedestrian 42" fencing, lighting, and signal design require coordination per BNSF standards.
- Multiple technical comments issued by BNSF for signage, queuing analysis, and pedestrian access.



Project Status and Updates

- 21st Street Closure Review - Warehouse 21

- Delivery Vehicle Types:

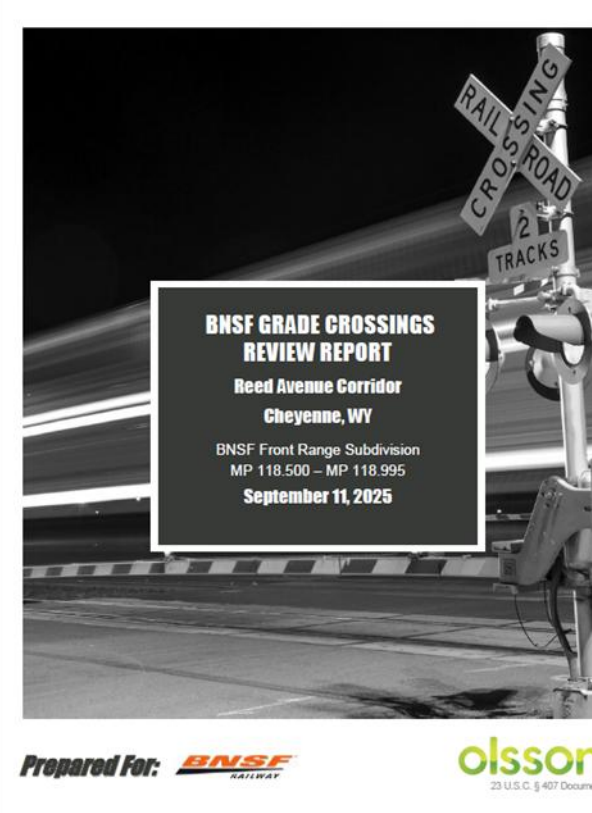
- Single-unit trucks (30–40 ft)
- Interstate semi-trailers (up to 67 ft)

- Traffic Frequency:

- Large semi-trailers cross the BNSF corridor 3–4 times/month, depending on client needs.

- Maneuvering Details:

- East to West: Requires encroachment into BNSF property to back into the dock.
- West to East: Crosses BNSF corridor but does not encroach during backing.



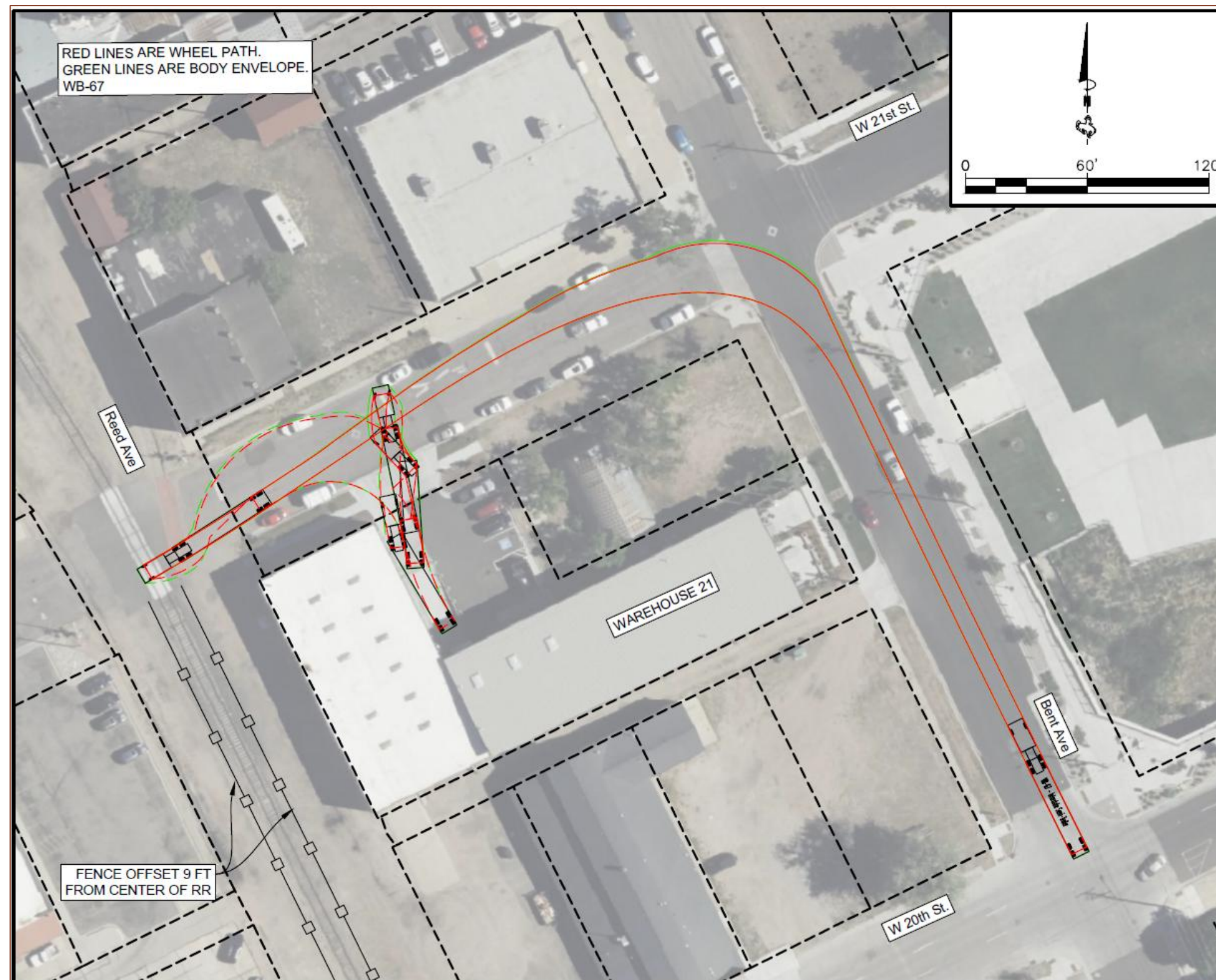
West 21st Street
BNSF Intersection
Crossing

Warehouse 21
Site

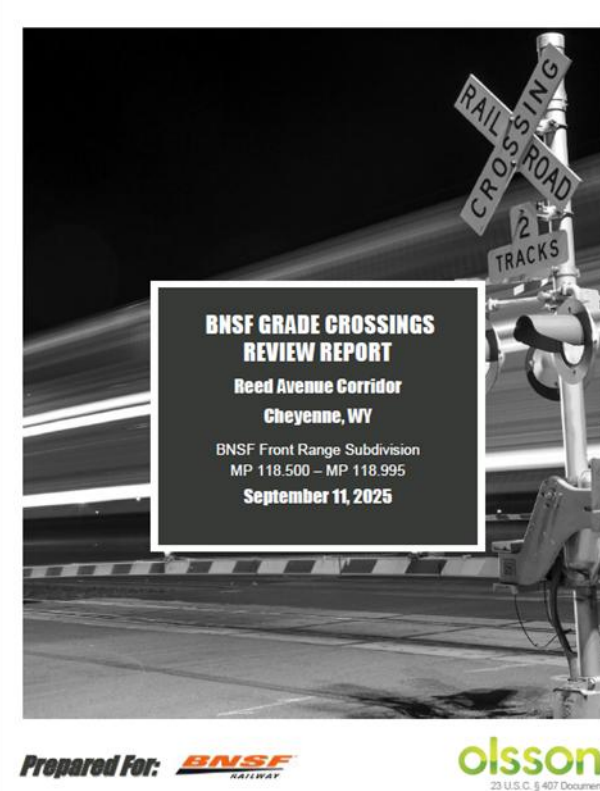
Meadow Gold
Site

Project Status and Updates

■ 21st Street Closure Review - Warehouse 21



Warehouse 21
Docking Area



Project Status and Updates

- 21st Street Closure Review – Meadow Gold

- Delivery Vehicle Types:

- Single-unit trucks (≈30 ft)
- Semi-trailers (up to 62 ft)

- Traffic Frequency:

- Large semi-trailers cross the BNSF corridor ≈4 times/day, based on demand.

- Maneuvering Details:

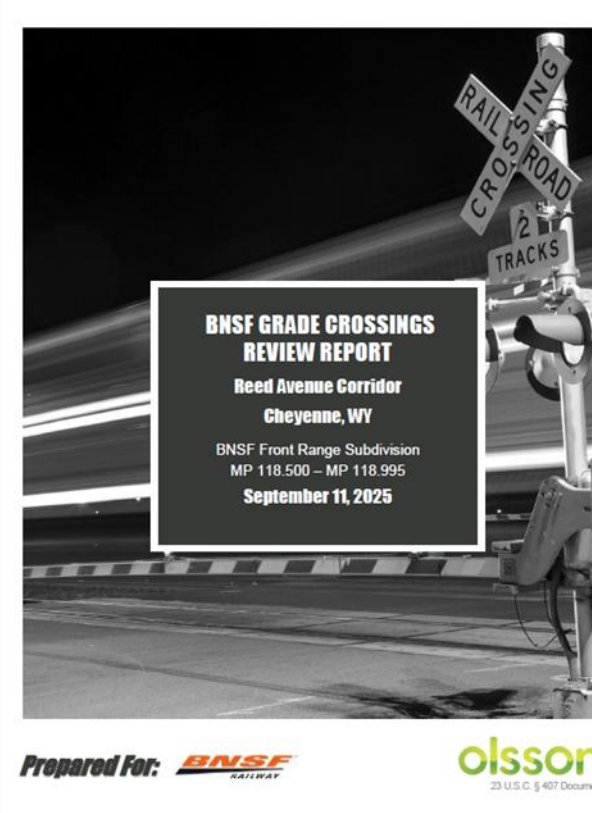
- East to West Route:
 - Crosses BNSF corridor to access north business approach
 - Exits via second approach onto Snyder Ave
 - Performs back-in maneuver to lower docks
- North to South Route
 - Utilizes Unsafe Maneuvers within Snyder Right-of-way
 - Difficult to navigate



West 21st Street
BNSF Intersection
Crossing

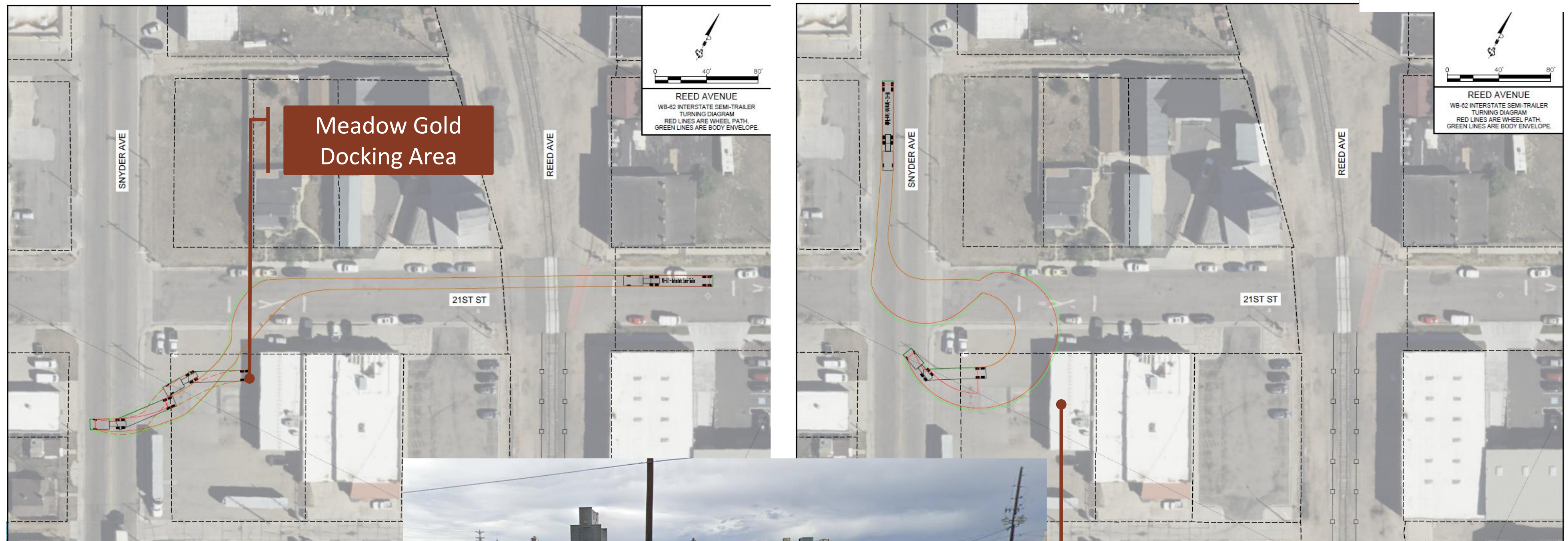
Warehouse 21
Site

Meadow Gold
Site

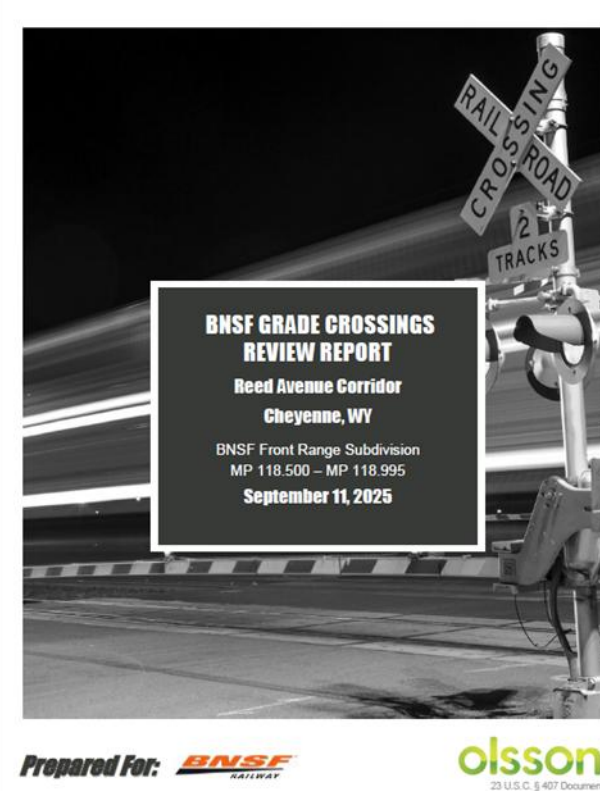


Project Status and Updates

■ 21st Street Closure Review – Meadow Gold



Meadow Gold Docking Area



Options for Opportunity to the 21st Street Closure

- **Create Public Parking Lot**
 - Utilize 21st Street
 - Purchase Parking Lots from Wyoming Lotto for potential public private partnership or business lease of spaces.
- **Develop a Pedestrian Connection to 20th Street and Civic Commons**
 - Add walkable connectivity to corridor and surrounding area



Project Status and Updates

- **City/Consultant Response to BNSF**
- **Crossing Review:**
 - Evaluated 4 potential crossing eliminations as part of the Reed Avenue Corridor Improvements Project.
 - Committed to 3 full closures:
 - 17th Street
 - 18th Street
 - Dillon Avenue
- **Impact Summary:**
 - Proposed closures eliminate 38% of existing crossings
 - Minimal impact to business operations
 - Safety concerns would increase with closure on roadway routes
 - No recorded accidents at current crossings



OFFICE OF THE CITY ENGINEER
2101 O'Neil Avenue, Room 206
Cheyenne, Wyoming 82001

Ms. Mary Ann Monaldi
Manager of Public Projects for Montana, Idaho
Burlington Northern Santa Fe, LLC. (BNSF)
3700 Globeville Rd.
Denver, Colorado 80216

Re: BNSF File No.: BF-20246698, Mile 1
U.S. DOT Number 245687Y, 245690G
245695R, Front Range Subdivision, T

Proposed Crossing Closures of Reed

Ms. Monaldi,

To begin, I would like to apologize for any co
with you on this project. Moving forward I a
BNSF and look forward to continued coordin
for our community.

The purpose of this letter is to follow up my
follow-up request from Mr. French Thompson
and Investments regarding the negative imp
business functionality imposed with a poten
provides a summary of all the roadway/ rail
completed along the corridor.

21st Street Roadway/ Rail Intersection Cl
We understand that BNSF requested the follo
Intersection closure: 1. Detailed AutoCAD A
operations of Meadow Gold and Warehouse 2
utilization over the crossings and current tru

Figure 1 - General Vicinity Map of 21st Stree
the letter to provide context and reference t



French F. Thompson III
General Director
Public Infrastructure and Investments

BNSF Railway Company
2600 Lou Menk Drive
Fort Worth, TX
817-352-1549
French.Thompson@bnsf.com

January 17, 2025

Dear Mr. Cobb,

BNSF Railway is firmly committed to enhancing public safety by eliminating rail crossings, as we strongly believe the safest crossing is one that does not exist.

As of January 17, 2025, BNSF has yet to receive the CAD drawings referenced in the previous letter. It is imperative for us to understand the operations of the businesses at the crossing and to review the in-depth option analysis that has been conducted. BNSF requires detailed CAD drawings that outline the truck operations of Meadow Gold and Warehouse 21. This analysis must include comprehensive information on truck utilization over the crossing and current truck operations within BNSF property limits.

If the closure of 21st Street crossing is in fact not feasible, BNSF requests the closure of an alternative public crossing in its place, bringing the total to four public crossing closures associated with the Reed Avenue Corridor Project.

Thank you for your prompt attention to this matter.

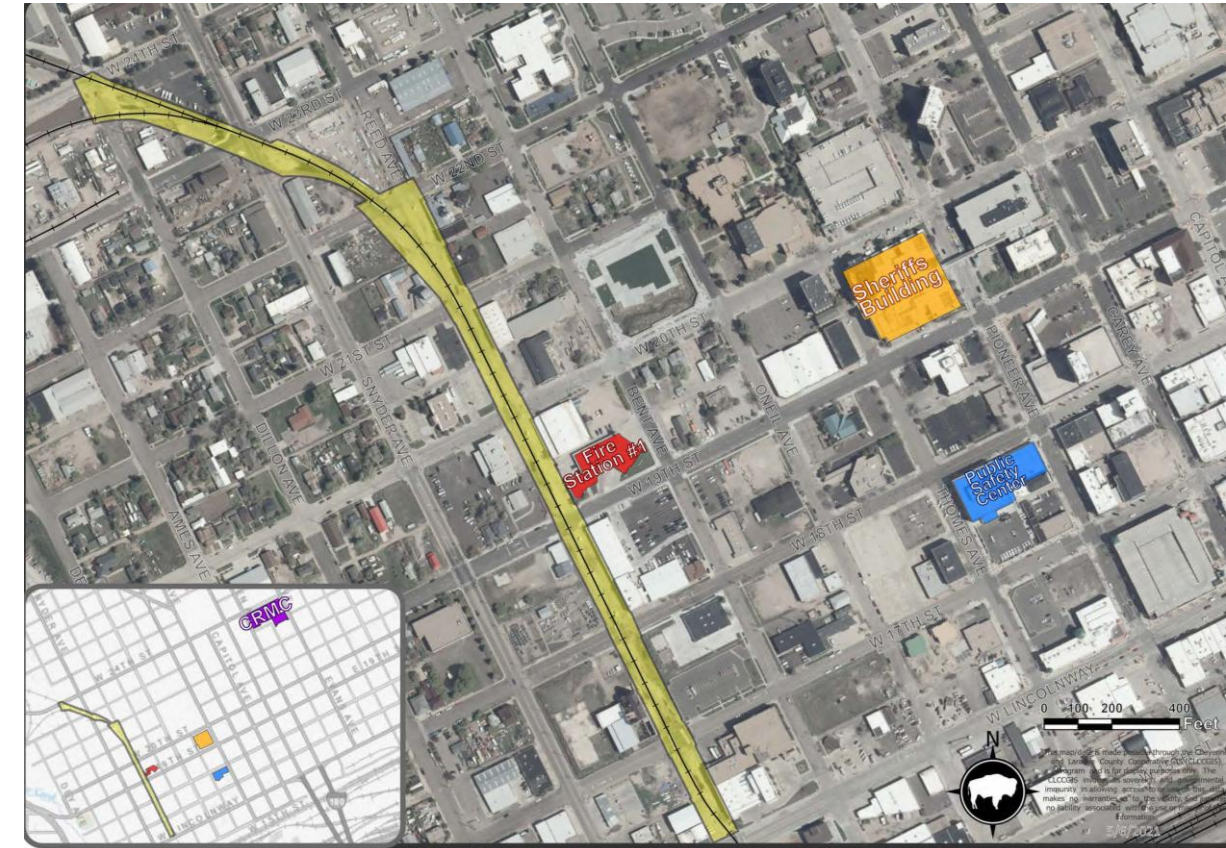
A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read "French F. Thompson III".

French F. Thompson III
General Director – Public Infrastructure and Investments
BNSF Railway

Project Status and Updates

■ Plan Development Next Steps

- City to finalize street closures and access modifications
- Coordinate lighting, queuing, and pedestrian studies
- Continue joint agency coordination (City, BNSF, WYDOT, UP)
- Incorporate comments into revised 60% design plans.
- Coordinate with BNSF and UPRR for field verification and estimate requests.
- Schedule follow-up diagnostic meetings as needed based on design changes.



Proposed Pilot Project

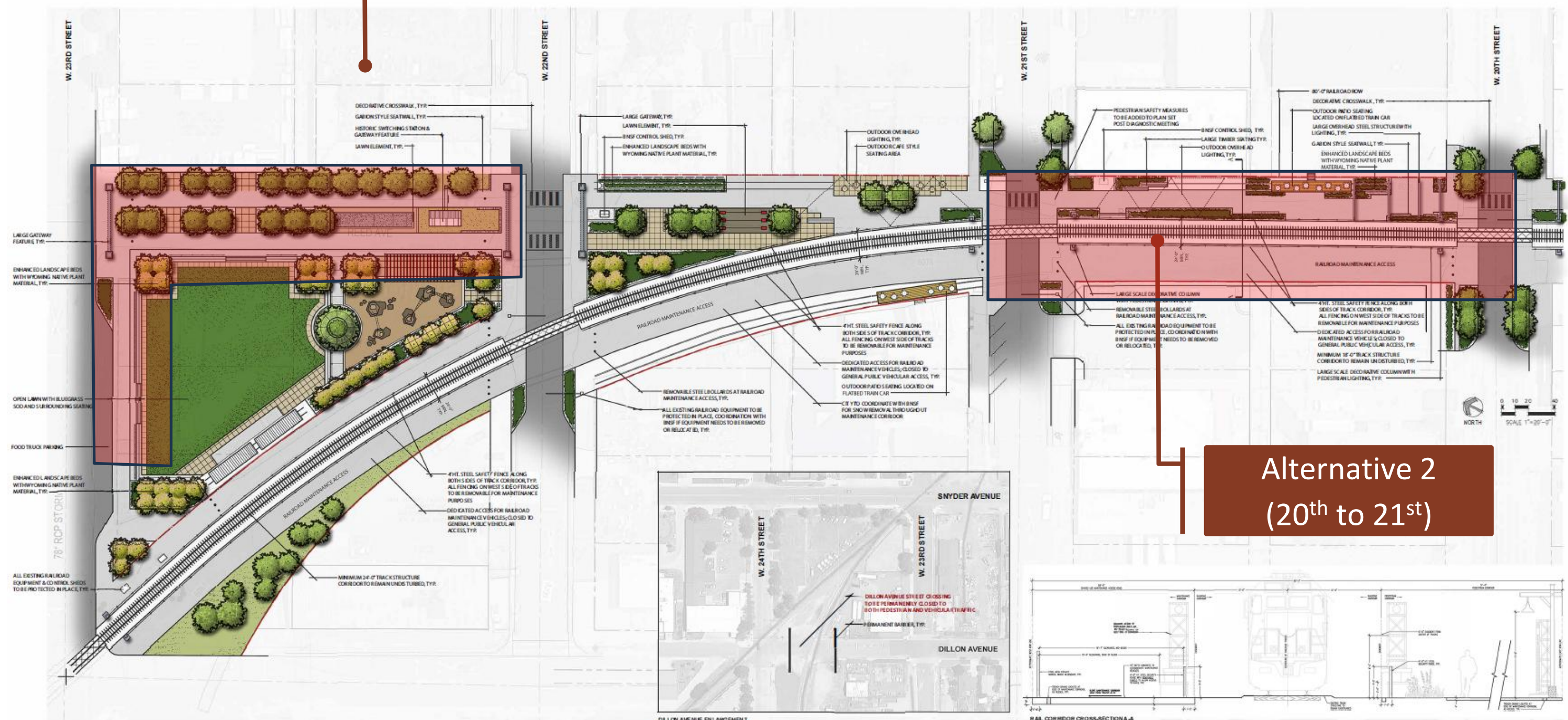
■ Alternative 1

- North edge of Reed Avenue Rail Corridor
- 23rd to 22nd Street
- Not within BNSF Right-of-way

■ Alternative 2

- Reed Avenue Rail Corridor
- 20th to 21st Street
- Within BNSF Right-of-way

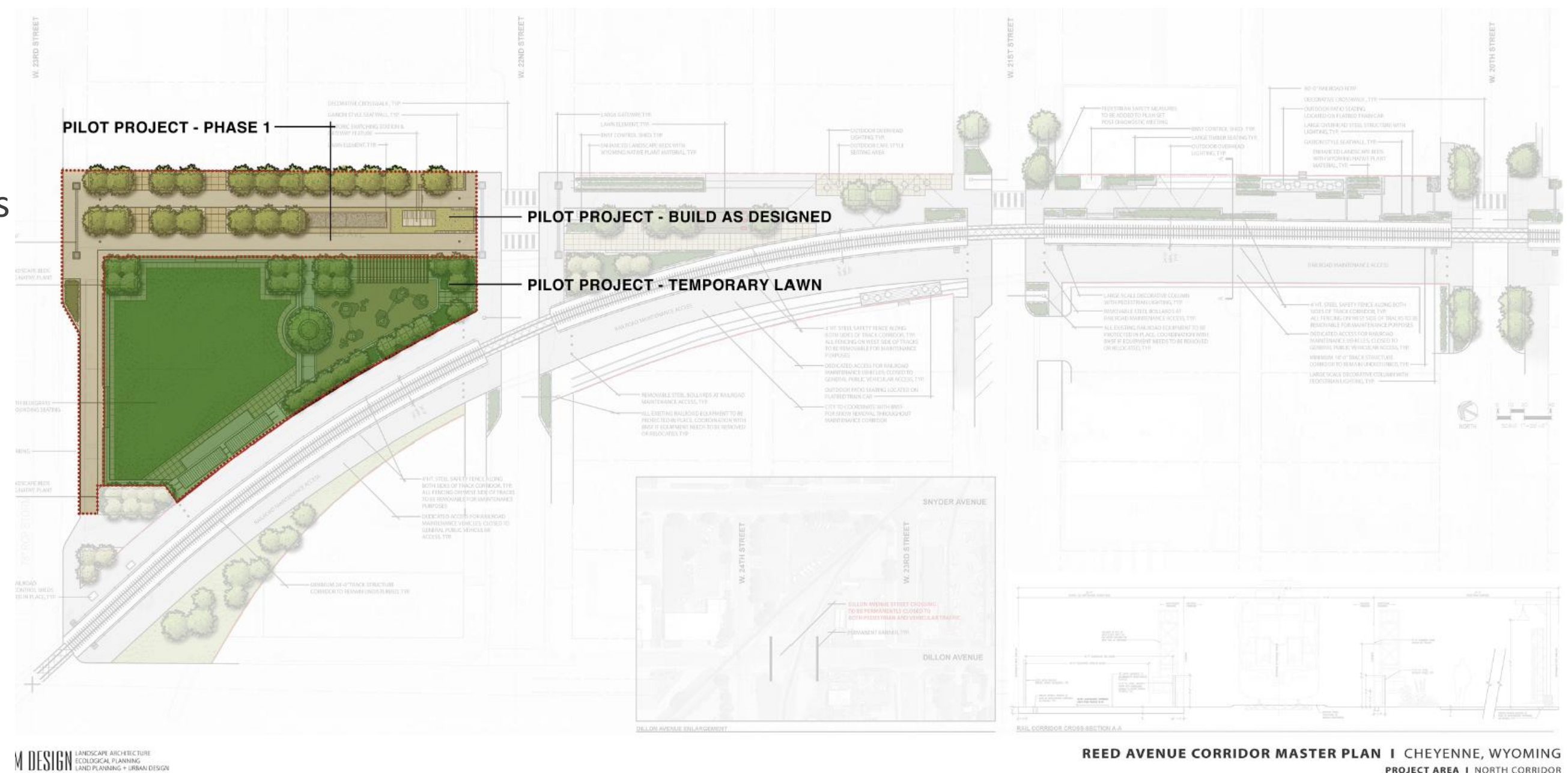
Alternative 1
(23rd to 22nd)



Alternative 2
(20th to 21st)

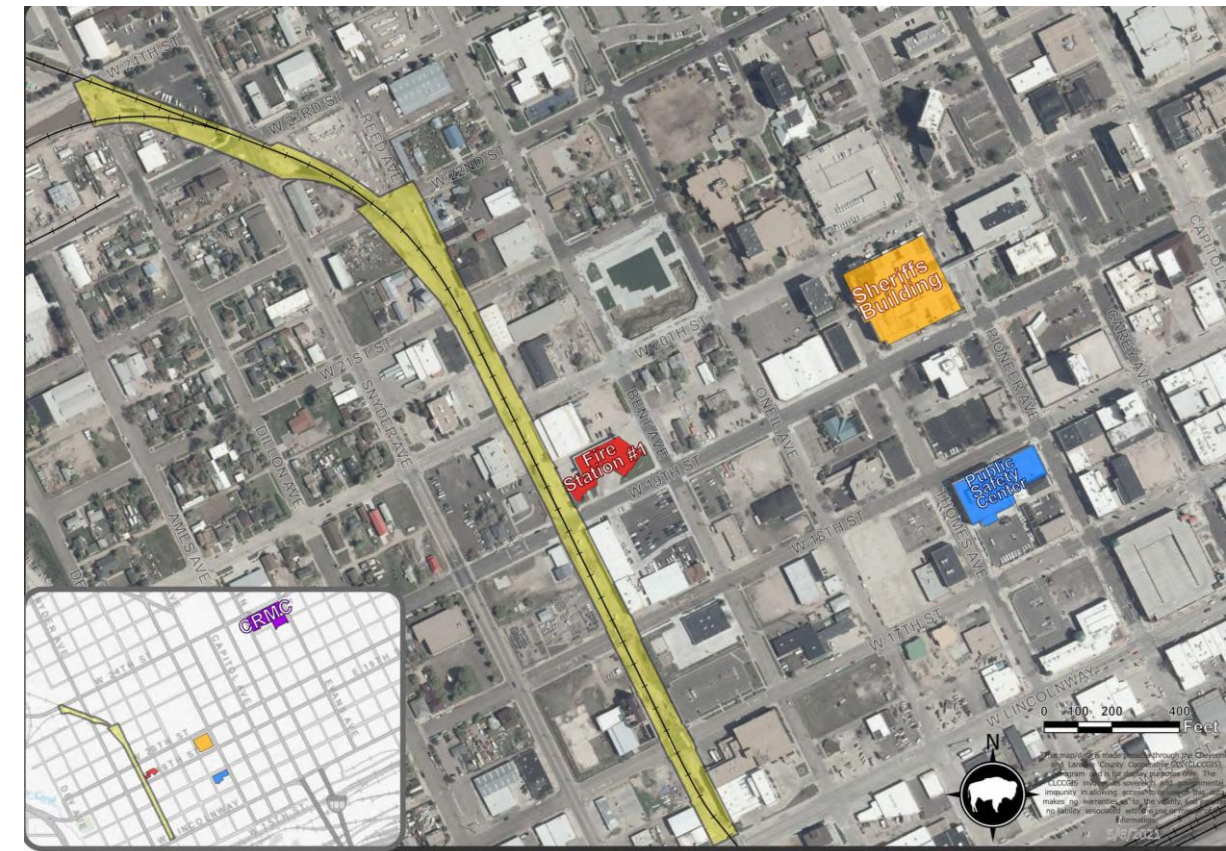
Proposed Pilot Project

- **Recommend Alternative 1**
 - North edge of Reed Avenue Rail Corridor
 - 23rd to 22nd Street
 - Located outside of BNSF Right-of-way
 - No BNSF oversight or jurisdictional delays
- **Purpose of the Pilot Project**
 - Demonstrate the long-term vision of the corridor
 - Leverage the remaining 6th Penny funds (\$1,459,487).
 - Generate community support for the broader 6th Penny Project Proposal
 - Build awareness, excitement, and trust through visible progress



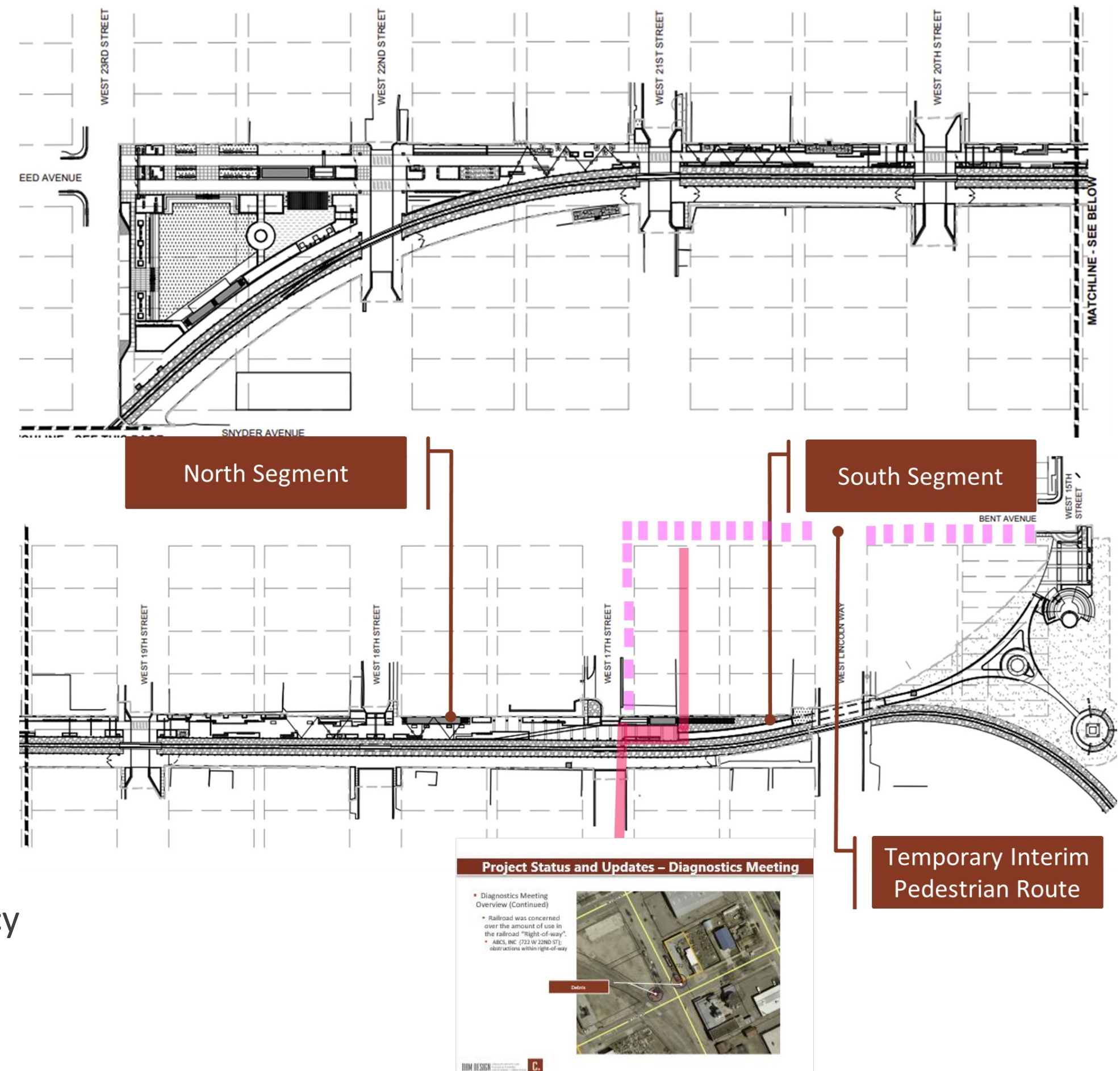
Next Steps – Anticipated Schedule

- **One-on one Meetings with Stakeholders**
 - October/ November 2025
- **2nd Public Meeting**
 - Proposed Mid January?
 - Location?
- **Steering Committee Meeting**
 - **Council Laybourn Report**
 - Last Meeting conducted on October 8, 2025
 - November 12, 2025 (2:30 p.m. – 4:00 p.m.)
- **100% Design Pilot Project**
 - Bid February, 2026
 - Construction Spring/ Summer 2026
- **60% Design Development Overall Project**
 - March 2026



6th Penny Project Proposal

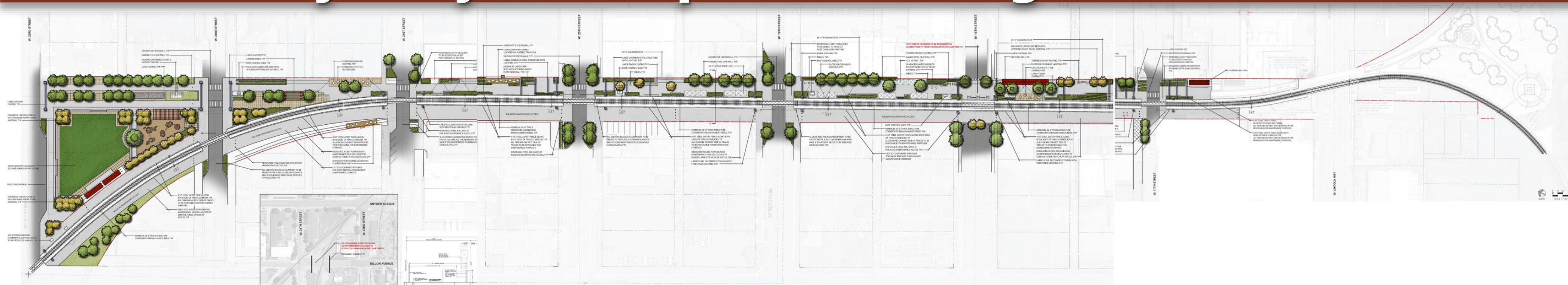
- Reed Avenue Corridor
 - Ensure realistic budget, attainable project limits, and a clear timeline of expectations
 - Consider a Two-component project?
- Recommendation: Proceed with North Segment Only
 - Rationale:
 - Pedestrian Underpass Complexity:
 - Requires coordination and approval from WYDOT, BNSF, and UPRR
 - Adds significant design and permitting challenges
 - Property Constraints:
 - Land south of Lincolnway is not currently leased or acquired
 - Access Concerns:
 - Removing portion of the south end of north segment simplifies BNSF approval and business access concerns
 - Jurisdictional Delays:
 - Focusing on the north segment avoids delays tied to multi-agency approvals



6th Penny Project Proposal – Existing Conditions



6th Penny Project Proposal – Design Foundation



■ Celebrate History

- Incorporate historic elements and materials to reflect the corridor's rail heritage.
- Reinforce a sense of place and identity rooted in Cheyenne's past.

■ Revitalization

- Reimagine the Reed Avenue Rail Corridor as a catalyst for economic growth.
- Attract entrepreneurs and reinvestment into the West Edge through infrastructure upgrades

■ Create Vibrant Public Space

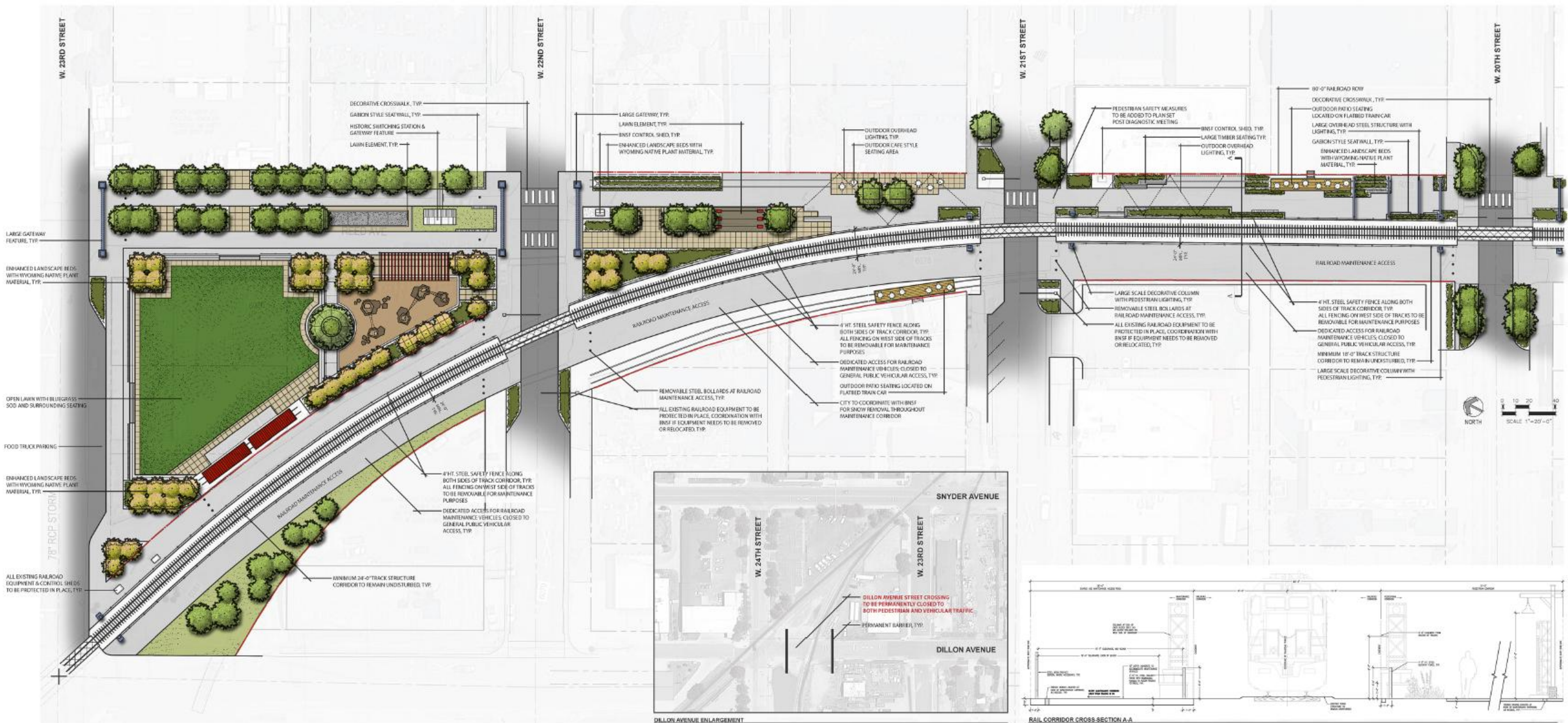
- Convert the corridor into a mixed-use pedestrian zone featuring:
 - Pedestrian and bicycle connectivity
 - Public amenities and green space
 - Social gathering areas that foster community interaction

■ Improve Safety

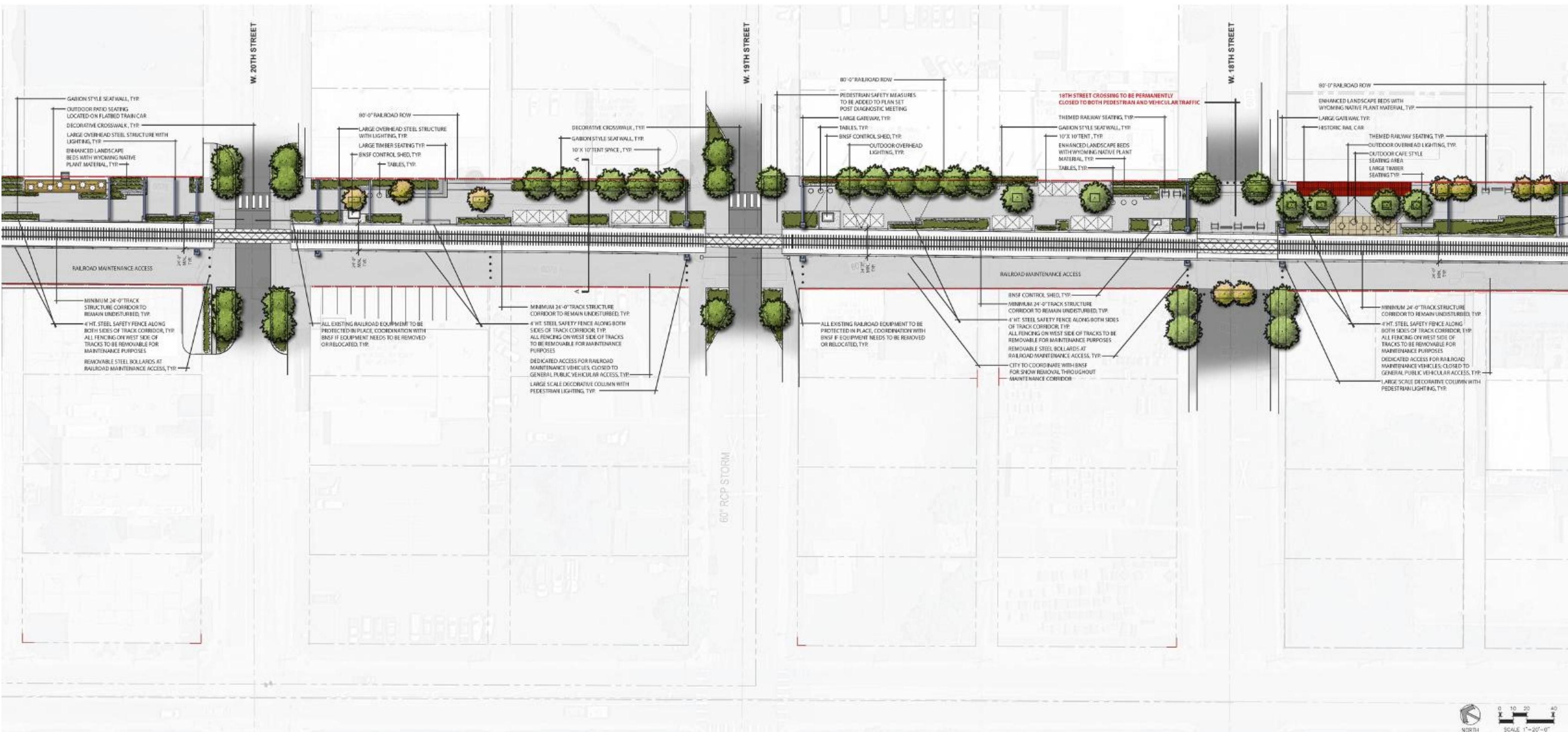
- Address current blighted conditions with a safe, welcoming environment.
- Integrate safety measures for the active rail line and surrounding public spaces.



6th Penny Project Proposal



6th Penny Project Proposal



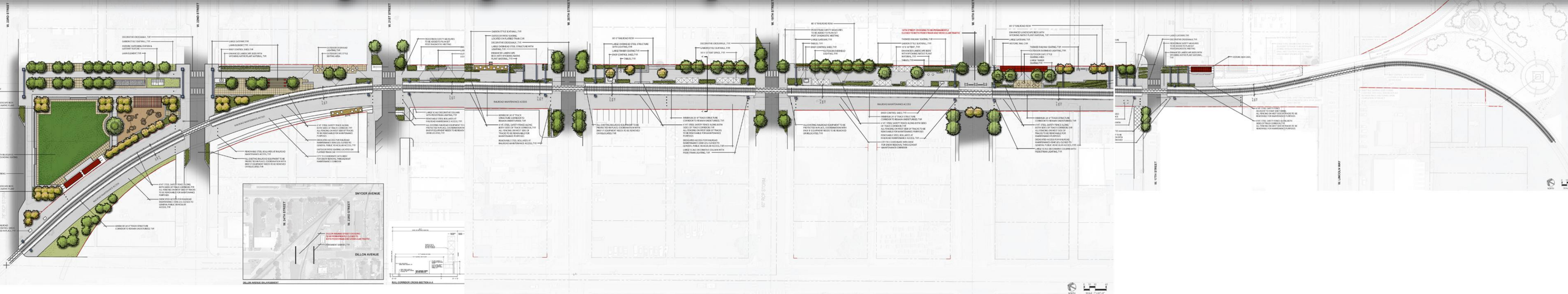
6th Penny Project Proposal

North Component

South Component

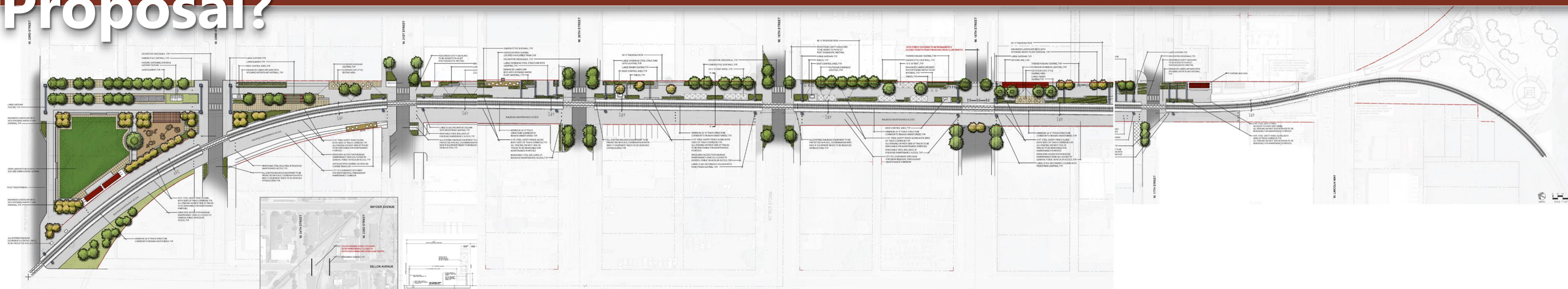
Temporary Interim
Pedestrian Route

6th Penny Project Proposal



Category	Subtotal
Mobilization	\$1,282,205.00
Demolition	\$315,000.00
Earthwork	\$36,000.00
Utilities	\$2,717,000.00
Site Lighting	\$675,000.00
Sitework & Hardscape	\$3,831,000.00
Railroad Improvements	\$100,000.00
Site Structures, Retaining Walls & Playground	\$846,500.00
Site Furnishings	\$2,050,000.00
Landscape & Irrigation	\$600,000.00
Construction Subtotal	\$12,452,705.00
20% Construction Contingency	\$2,490,541.00
Total Estimated Construction Cost	\$14,943,246.00

Why Reed Avenue Corridor - 6th Penny Project Proposal?



- Transform Reed Avenue into a safe, accessible, and vibrant corridor.
- Aligns with City of Cheyenne's long-term infrastructure, community, and council goals.
- Fulfills 2017 Voter Commitments
 - Advances the City's original promise to complete the Reed Avenue Corridor, as outlined in the 6th Penny ballot initiative.
 - Demonstrates accountability and follow-through on publicly supported infrastructure priorities.
- Supports Private Investment & Economic Growth
 - Enhances infrastructure to unlock adjacent private development potential.
 - Improves access, safety, and aesthetics — key factors in attracting and retaining businesses.
- Addresses Critical Infrastructure Needs
 - Resolves long-standing stormwater and utility issues.
 - Improves multimodal access and public safety for pedestrians, cyclists, and vehicles.
- Total Estimated Cost: \$14.9 M (2025 Dollars)
 - Based on 30% Concept Design Plans
 - 20% Contingency
 - Design uncertainty,
 - Market volatility,
 - Unforeseen conditions,
 - Inflation

Reed Avenue Rail Corridor – 6th Penny Presentation

October 10, 2025



Thank you!